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Intro To Music Theory For The Traditional Musician

by Jim Miller



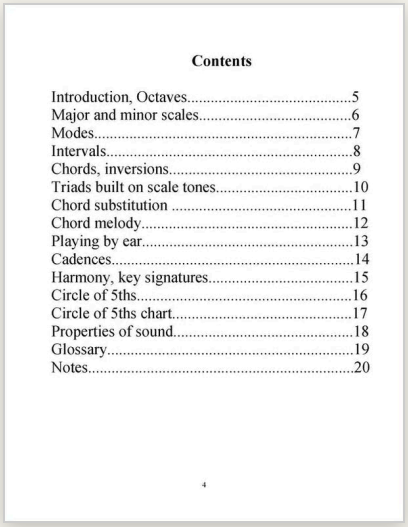
Jim Miller's Intro To Music Theory For The Traditional Musician explains music theory basics in plain, easy-to-understand language, for players of any instrument.

Topics include intervals, scales, chords and modes, and the understanding it gives you will make playing by ear easier.

16 pages. Formerly titled Intro To Music Theory For The Harmonically Challenged.

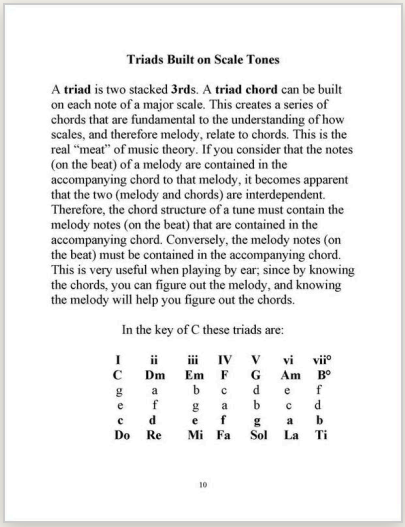
16 pages

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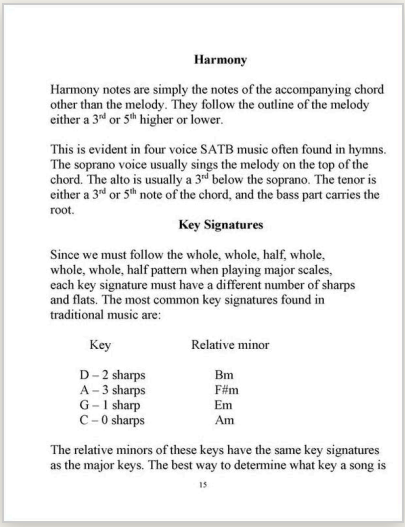


Triads Built on Scale Tones

A **triad** is two stacked **3rd**s. A **triad chord** can be built on each note of a major scale. This creates a series of chords that are fundamental to the understanding of how scales, and therefore melody, relate to chords. This is the real "meat" of music theory. If you consider that the notes (on the beat) of a melody are contained in the accompanying chord to that melody, it becomes apparent that the two (melody and chords) are interdependent. Therefore, the chord structure of a tune must contain the melody notes (on the beat) that are contained in the accompanying chord. Conversely, the melody notes (on the beat) must be contained in the accompanying chord. This is very useful when playing by ear; since by knowing the chords, you can figure out the melody, and knowing the melody will help you figure out the chords.

In the key of C these triads are:

I	ii	iii	IV	V	vi	vii°
C	**Dm**	**Em**	**F**	**G**	**Am**	**B°**
g	a	b	c	d	e	f
e	f	g	a	b	c	d
c	**d**	**e**	**f**	**g**	**a**	**b**
Do	**Re**	**Mi**	**Fa**	**Sol**	**La**	**Ti**



Harmony

Harmony notes are simply the notes of the accompanying chord other than the melody. They follow the outline of the melody either a 3rd or 5th higher or lower.

This is evident in four voice SATB music often found in hymns. The soprano voice usually sings the melody on the top of the chord. The alto is usually a 3rd below the soprano. The tenor is either a 3rd or 5th note of the chord, and the bass part carries the root.

Key Signatures

Since we must follow the whole, whole, half, whole, whole, whole, half pattern when playing major scales, each key signature must have a different number of sharps and flats. The most common key signatures found in traditional music are:

Key	Relative minor
D – 2 sharps	Bm
A – 3 sharps	F#m
G – 1 sharp	Em
C – 0 sharps	Am

The relative minors of these keys have the same key signatures as the major keys. The best way to determine what key a song is

ISBN 978-1-964725-86-4
Published by
Fingers Of Steel®

Printed book folkcraft.com
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